How Top Short-Form Editors Write Their Employment History on Upwork

For: Harry, short-form video editor in Lagos (title now: "Short-Form Video Editor | Reels, TikTok & YouTube Shorts") **Data pulled:** 27 October 2026, live from Upwork. **40 freelancers:** 16 Nigerians, 12 from other countries, 12 with no Top Rated badge. **Paid (boosted) rows:** none. Every ranking below is organic.

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1. Short answer

- **Employment history does not seem to push people up the search.** The two best Nigerian rankers (Emmanuel E., avg rank 1.3; Isaac T., 1.7) have 5 and 1 entries. The three Nigerians with 100 entries had the worst average rank of the group (about 17).
- **The most common style is simple:** a real small company or client (or "Freelance", "Self-Employed", "Upwork") plus a plain job title like "Video Editor".
- **Some put search words into the job title** (for example "Short Form Video Editor", "Reels, Tiktok & Shorts Editor"), and a few even put them in the company name. This is not needed to rank.
- **The profile title does the heavy lifting.** Almost everyone uses: `[Role] | [TikTok, Reels, Shorts] & [one niche]`.
- **The overview follows one pattern:** hook → who I help → proof → services list → tools → call to action (often a free sample) → short keyword list.
- **What seems to lift rank most (our reading, not an Upwork fact):** exact buyer phrases in the title and overview, many recent small contracts, and a high Job Success Score.
- **Fake big brands, 100 invented jobs and fake schools did not buy top ranks.** Avoid them.

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2. Two limits you should know first

(a) What the data tools can see. For employment, the Upwork data tools return only the **company name and the job title**. They do **not** return dates or descriptions. They return **no "Other experience" section at all**. So the employment lists below are complete for company and title, but we cannot show what people wrote in their descriptions.

(b) How "ranking" was measured. Uma (Upwork's AI) ranks freelancers for clients, but that ranking is only visible to a client on their own job post. We cannot see it. So we used the closest thing we can measure: **how many searches each person appears in, and their average position** in those searches.

- Nigerians: 8 searches filtered to Nigeria (short form, TikTok, Reels, YouTube Shorts, UGC, CapCut, podcast clips, video editor), top 25 each.

- Other countries and no-badge: 7 open searches (no country filter) plus 4 "Rising Talent" searches, top 25 each.

"(our reading)" in this report means it is our interpretation, not a fact from Upwork.

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3. The freelancers

How to read each block: **Stats** = badge · earnings · jobs · Job Success Score (JSS). **Searches** = how many searches they appeared in and their average position (lower is better). Employment is written as **Company — Job title**, exactly as on the profile (typos kept). ⚠ = red flag.

3A. Nigerians (16)

1. Emmanuel E. — Nigeria (Akwa Ibom)

- Stats: Top Rated · $20K+ · 219 jobs · JSS 100 · $5/hr
- Searches: 7 of 8 · avg rank **1.3**
- Title: "YouTube Video Editor | Short & Long Form | TikTok & Instagram Reels"
- Employment (5):
  - Auxano Project — Video editor, creation, social media manager and content writing
  - Tencent Holdings — Video editor and producer,
  - Vesterhave Vingaard — Video editor, content writing
  - NEAR Protocol — Video Editor, Social Media Manager
  - Michaels Kors — Graphic Designer
- Pattern: Mixes small names with famous brands; titles stack several roles. Overview has a "My Expertise" list, a tools list and a "Key Skills" keyword block.
- ⚠ Big brands (Tencent, NEAR Protocol, misspelled "Michaels Kors") with no proof. ETH Zurich master's degree clashes with "over a year of experience".

2. Isaac T. — Nigeria (Lagos)

- Stats: No badge · $1K+ · 40 jobs · JSS 95 · $10/hr
- Searches: 6 of 8 · avg rank **1.7**
- Title: "YouTube Sports Video Editor | NBA, NFL, Shorts & Reels"
- Employment (1):
  - Self Employed — YouTube Video Editor | Shorts & Sports Editor
- Pattern: One "Self Employed" entry whose job title copies his profile title. Ranks top-2 with no badge; he had about 10 new contracts in Sept–Oct 2026 (our reading: activity matters).
- ⚠ Overview list is broken (words split across lines).

3. Edmond O. — Nigeria (Rivers)

- Stats: Top Rated Plus · $100K+ · 225 jobs · JSS 98 · $25/hr
- Searches: 6 of 8 · avg rank 4.3

- Title: "Direct Response, UGC, AI, VSL Ads Creative Director & Video Editor"
- Employment (1):
  - Oranje Media — video editor
- Pattern: Highest earner, thinnest employment. Keyword work is in the overview: "My Achievements" metrics list plus a ~30-term keyword dump at the end.

4. Anu F. (Anuoluwapo) — Nigeria (Ogun)

- Stats: Top Rated Plus · $50K+ · 196 jobs · JSS 100 · $15/hr
- Searches: 6 of 8 · avg rank 4.7
- Title: "Video Editor & AI Filmmaker | YouTube, Podcasts & AI Video"
- Employment (5):
  - Upwork — Expert Podcast & Vlog Video Editor at Upwork
  - Story Teller Media NG — Video Editor & Motion Graphics Artist at Story Teller Media NG
  - Detrix Studios — Creative Director & Video Editor at Detrix Studios
  - Wedding Channel Africa — Wedding Video Editor Specialist at Wedding Channel Africa
  - Xteam Studios — Professional Video Editor & Storyteller at Xteam Studios
- Pattern: Real Nigerian studios plus "Upwork". Every title uses " at ". Portfolio titles are written like search headlines.

5. Geraldine O. — Nigeria (Lagos)

- Stats: No badge · $2K+ · 17 jobs · JSS 81 · $10/hr
- Searches: 5 of 8 · avg rank 5.8
- Title: "VSL & Meta Ad Creative Video Editor | AI UGC ads, Long & Shorts, Reels"
- Employment (2):
  - FitLyss Lifestyle — Youtube Video Editor
  - Multichoice Africa — Videographer and Video Editor
- Pattern: A client channel plus a big African media brand; plain titles. Overview ends with a raw keyword list added for search.
- ⚠ Multichoice Africa cannot be checked. Six contracts closed within 6 minutes on one day; several hourly jobs paid $4.50–$6/hr.

6. Favour I. — Nigeria (Abuja)

- Stats: No badge · $8K+ · 10 jobs · JSS 83 · $12/hr
- Searches: 7 of 8 · avg rank 6.9
- Title: "Short-Form Video Editor | Talking Head Reels, TikTok & Podcast Clips"
- Employment (3):
  - Simplify Synergy International — Content creator and Video editor
  - Simplify Synergy — Content creator and Video editor
  - Style by Lucid — Content creator and Video editor
- Pattern: Client names with the same plain title three times (one client listed twice). Ranks high from a keyword-rich title and long overview.

7. Alonge T. — Nigeria (Lagos)

- Stats: Top Rated · $3K+ · 48 jobs · JSS 93 · $15/hr
- Searches: 7 of 8 · avg rank 8.1
- Title: "YouTube Video Editor for Sports | NFL, NBA, MMA, Soccer | Short-form"
- Employment (3):
  - reelance Sports Video Specialist — Lead Video Editor | Short-Form Content & MMA Specialist
  - Visual Brand & Graphics (Freelance) — Graphic Designer | YouTube Branding & Thumbnail Specialist
  - Elite Sports Media (Freelance) — Lead Video Editor | Short-Form & MMA Specialist
- Pattern: His own invented freelance "brands", marked "(Freelance)". Job titles use pipes and niche keywords, like a profile title.
- ⚠ Typo "reelance" left in a company name.

8. Ayomide O. — Nigeria (Lagos)

- Stats: Top Rated Plus · $50K+ · 82 jobs · JSS 100 · $20/hr
- Searches: 5 of 8 · avg rank 8.8
- Title: "Performance Video Editor | Paid Ads, Short-Form & YouTube Content"
- Employment (2):
  - spines — video editor
  - Atlas News — video editor
- Pattern: Two words per entry, lowercase. Keywords live in the overview (results list, testimonials) and portfolio descriptions instead.

9. Ejiofor J. — Nigeria (Ogun)

- Stats: Top Rated · $3K+ · 23 jobs · JSS 100 · $17/hr
- Searches: 4 of 8 · avg rank 10.8
- Title: "AI UGC Ad | AI Video Ad | TikTok, Meta & Product Video"
- Employment: **100 entries** (the tools stop at 100, so there may be more). The notes do not pair every company with its title. Examples:
  - Companies: "AI Video Editor | Meta & TikTok Ads | UGC | Ecommerce | DTC | Video Ads" (×3) · Elite AI Commerce · Waymo Studios · Freelance (Self-Employed) · InfinitePulse Entertainment
  - Job titles: "AI UGC Ads Producer | AI Product Ads Specialist" · "AI Product Video Creator | AI Video Ads Editor" · "AI UGC Video Creator | Meta & TikTok Product Ads"
- Pattern: Uses profile-title strings as company names (about 28), about 60 invented agency names, and job titles that shuffle the same keywords. Same ~55-word keyword block pasted 3 times in the overview.
- ⚠ Invented companies, "Waymo Studios" borrows a real brand, fake schools ("AI UGC Advertising Specialist" as a university), 311 portfolio items.

10. Chris C. — Nigeria (Lagos)

- Stats: No badge (text still says Top Rated) · $20K+ · 72 jobs · JSS 100 · $28/hr
- Searches: 3 of 8 · avg rank 12.0
- Title: "Video Editor | Reels, Shorts, TikToks, Courses | Edits That Hook"
- Employment (1):
  - IO Filmworks — Professional video editor
- Pattern: One plain entry. Overview openly says: "I've included a keyword section below to help make this page more searchable and aligned with Upwork's matching system", then a ~27-term list.
- ⚠ Overview claims Top Rated; the badge is not shown.

11. Jules . — Nigeria (location field says "CORSICA")

- Stats: Top Rated · $6K+ (video + software) · 27 jobs · JSS 100 · $15/hr
- Searches: 6 of 8 · avg rank 12.7
- Title: "Short-Form Video Editor | Reels, TikTok & AI-Assisted Ads"
- Employment (4):
  - Self-Employed — Freelance Video Editor
  - Bluekivi — Backend Engineer (Sole Backend Owner)
  - Martial QA (remote, South Africa) — Django Backend Engineer (SaaS Systems)
  - DoWell Research Pte. Ltd. — 🏢Backend-Focused Full Stack Engineer (Django)
- Pattern: Honest career switch: one freelance video entry plus three real software jobs. Best-written overview (proof → what I edit → how it works → "send one raw clip" offer).

12. Paula E. — Nigeria (Abuja)

- Stats: Top Rated Plus · $10K+ · 13 jobs · JSS 100 · $15/hr
- Searches: 4 of 8 · avg rank 14.0
- Title: "Short-Form Video Editor | Reels, TikTok & Youtube Shorts, Talking-Head"
- Employment (3):
  - Mastribe — Creative Content Creator
  - Xplicit Mode — Content Creator & Editor
  - Jubilee Systems — Content Creator & Social Media Manger
- Pattern: Small real businesses, plain titles. Overview ends with a short pipe keyword line. One $10K client made her Top Rated Plus.
- ⚠ Typo "Manger".

13. Oluwatoba A. (Toba) — Nigeria (Lagos)

- Stats: Top Rated · $5K+ · 24 jobs · JSS 100 · $20/hr
- Searches: 4 of 8 · avg rank 14.8
- Title: "Short-Form Video Editor | TikTok, Reels, YouTube Shorts & Ad Creatives"
- Employment (3):
  - Freelance — Video Editor
  - Freelancer — Freelancer

    - Freelancer — Freelancer
- Pattern: No effort on employment at all, yet ranks in 4 searches. Honest overview, no keyword dump.

14. Chinenyenwa Faustina E. — Nigeria (Lagos)

- Stats: Top Rated · $4K+ · 14 jobs · JSS 100 · $5/hr
- Searches: 7 of 8 · avg rank 17.4
- Title: "Short-Form Video Editor & Content Repurposing Expert | TikTok, IG Reel"
- Employment (5):
    - teacher chisquare — video editor
    - Lincharl — Video editor/social media manager /content creator
    - Enterprise Life Nigeria — Sales Representative
    - Prime Solutions Enterprise — Customer Support Specialist
    - Chok Auto limited — Customer Service
- Pattern: Real local jobs, including non-video ones, written plainly. Shows up in 7 searches, so polish is not needed to be found.

15. Kazeem M. — Nigeria (Lagos)

- Stats: No badge · $4K+ · 27 jobs · JSS 100 · $15/hr
- Searches: 5 of 8 · avg rank 20.2
- Title: "Video Editor | Short-Form, UGC & Meta/TikTok Video Ads"
- Employment: **100 entries**, about 90 added in one sitting (our reading). 5 examples:
    - Lagos Street Food Brand — UGC Campaign Creator
    - Dubai Luxury Real Estate Firm — Campaign Editor
    - Tokyo Gaming Startup — Short-Form Content editor
    - Fiverr — Youtube and Google Ads video
    - Berlly exchange — Financial Analyst
- Pattern: Client "descriptions" by city and industry instead of real names. Short niche job titles; 40 of 100 contain short/reel/shorts/tiktok/ugc.
- ⚠ Likely invented clients. Portfolio items copy client job posts word for word. Two $10 contracts with long glowing reviews. Still ranks only #18–23.

16. Nawwal I. — Nigeria (Kwara)

- Stats: No badge · $3K+ · 18 jobs · JSS 100 · $10/hr
- Searches: 5 of 8 · avg rank 20.6
- Title: "Instagram Reels Editor for Wellness Brands | UGC & Short-Form Video"
- Employment: **100 entries**, added in about 5 batches (our reading). 5 examples:
    - TrendHive Electronics — INSTAGRAM REELS & AI VIDEO EDITOR | UGC & SHORT-FORM VIDEO
    - GlowCart Beauty — INSTAGRAM REELS & AI VIDEO EDITOR | UGC & BEAUTY SHORT-FORM CONTENT

    - THG (The Hut Group) — INSTAGRAM REELS & AI VIDEO STRATEGIST | UGC, BEAUTY & WELLNESS
    - Publicis Groupe — INSTAGRAM REELS & AI VIDEO SPECIALIST | UGC & PERFORMANCE CONTENT
    - SocialSpark Studio — AI Video Designer
- Pattern: Invented brand names plus two real multinationals. About 99 of 100 titles use the same ALL-CAPS keyword template.
- ⚠ Invented brands; THG and Publicis name-drops; six $5 contracts (three on one day); review wording copied into the overview. Still ranks only #16–24.

3B. Other countries (12)

1. Hafsa H. — Pakistan

- Stats: Top Rated Plus · $70K+ · 509 jobs · JSS 90 · $5/hr
- Searches: 7 of 7 · avg rank 10.4
- Title: "YouTube Video Editor | Reels, Shorts & Motion Graphics"
- Employment (2):
    - Lamore Digital — Video Editor
    - Freelancer — Video Editor
- Pattern: Two plain entries. Shows up in every search because of a huge job history and about 10 new contracts in 2 weeks (our reading).

2. Giang P. — Vietnam

- Stats: Top Rated · $50K+ · 332 jobs · JSS 96 · $10/hr
- Searches: 6 of 7 · avg rank 9.3
- Title: "Professional Video Editor | YouTube, Ads, Shorts, Reels, TikTok"
- Employment (2):
    - FPT Arena Multimedia — Visual Design
    - S&P Global — video editer
- Pattern: A training school plus a big brand; plain titles. Keywords sit in the title and the "What I Work On" list.
- ⚠ S&P Global cannot be checked; typo "editer".

3. Luong Tan D. (Duy) — Vietnam

- Stats: Top Rated · $30K+ · 211 jobs · JSS 94 · $15/hr
- Searches: 5 of 7 · avg rank **4.0**
- Title: "Video Editing | Short-Form Video Editor | YouTube Videos | Meta Ads"
- Employment (2):
    - Video Editor | Big Agency's — Video Editing
    - Social Media Marketing | Content Creator | Youtube Video Editor — Video Editor
- Pattern: Puts keywords in the **company** field; no real company names. Overview offers a free 30-second demo.

4. Abdullah D. — Pakistan

- Stats: Top Rated · $50K+ · 360 jobs · JSS 100 · $30/hr
- Searches: 5 of 7 · avg rank 13.6
- Title: "Talking-Head Video Editor | YouTube, VSL & Reels | Motion Graphics"
- Employment (1):
  - MyPackagingPro — Video Editor / Graphic Designer / Product Designer
- Pattern: One real client with stacked roles. Overview opens with proof (badge, JSS, jobs, earnings) and uses ALL-CAPS section headers.

5. Syed Muhammad A. (Affan) — Pakistan

- Stats: Top Rated Plus · earnings not shown · 318 jobs · JSS 98 · $19.99/hr
- Searches: 5 of 7 · avg rank 15.4
- Title: "Short-Form Video Editor | UGC Ads | VSL | Reels & TikTok | Get Sales"
- Employment (6):
  - Alch3m1st — Video Editing Manager
  - OAM Digital — Short-Form Video Editor Specialist
  - The Monetization Group (MON Group) — Full Stack Video Expert
  - SWISH Marketing Agency — Video Editing Manager
  - Smarty AI — Short-Form Video Expert
  - Times Consultant — Video Editor Intern
- Pattern: Agency names; titles add "Short-Form" and show growth (Intern → Manager). Overview ends with "Keywords for UMA and Client Matching:" (~60 phrases).
- ⚠ All 6 added in one sitting; says "290+" and "260+" projects in the same overview.

6. Umair T. — Pakistan

- Stats: Top Rated · $5K+ · 45 jobs · JSS 100 · $10/hr
- Searches: 5 of 7 · avg rank 15.4
- Title: "Professional Video Editor for YouTube, Ads & Social Media"
- Employment (3):
  - NovaCore Game Labs — Creative Media & Technical Designer | NovaCore Game Labs
  - PixelForge Technologies — Visual Content Developer | PixelForge Technologies
  - Vertex Interactive Studios — Junior Visual Designer
- Pattern: Company name repeated inside the title; not video titles. Plain, generic overview still ranks.
- ⚠ Generic-sounding names, added in one batch, cannot be checked.

7. Fawas P. — India

- Stats: Top Rated Plus · $400K+ · 886 jobs · JSS 99 · $15/hr
- Searches: 4 of 7 · avg rank 4.5
- Title: "Certified Youtube Strategist | 10 Years Of Experience | Video Editor"
- Employment (1):

    - Vishfa Digital Solutions — Co Founder
- Pattern: Own agency as co-founder. Overview has an emoji proof stack and "Keywords for Finding Me:" block. Huge history carries him.

8. Van Trung N. (Trung) — Vietnam

- Stats: Top Rated · $20K+ · 175 jobs · JSS 100 · $15/hr
- Searches: 4 of 7 · avg rank 9.2 (#1 for "UGC video editor")
- Title: "Video Editor | Short-Form, YouTube, Tiktok, Meta Ads, VSL & AI UGC"
- Employment (2):
    - TP Entertainment — Video Editor
    - Ebay E-commerce Company — Management Online Store and Promotion Video
- Pattern: Plain titles. Portfolio titles carry platform keywords.
- ⚠ "Ebay E-commerce Company" reads like a big-brand name-drop.

9. Kaiwan I. — Pakistan

- Stats: Top Rated · earnings not shown · 101 jobs · JSS 95 · $5/hr
- Searches: 4 of 7 · avg rank 17.8
- Title: "Expert Video Editor | Short Reel | VSL Video Edit | Short Video Editor"
- Employment (7):
    - Hill Studio Solutions — Video Ad Creator
    - Dynamic Edit Studio Solutions — YouTube Video Editor
    - Editopia Pvt Ltd — Motion Graphics Expert
    - Cinematic Creations Pvt Ltd — Video Design Expert
    - Cinematic Creations Pvt Ltd — Social Media Video Specialist
    - Cinematix Pvt Ltd — Video Production Specialist
    - Video Production Solutions — Video Editing Expert
- Pattern: One service keyword per entry, generic studio names. Overview hides a keyword string repeated 25+ times below ~40 blank lines.
- ⚠ Looks like keyword farming; 6 of 7 added in one batch. Weak average rank.

10. Minh K. — Vietnam

- Stats: Top Rated · $4K+ · 25 jobs · JSS 100 · $10/hr
- Searches: 3 of 7 · avg rank 4.0 (#1 for "Reels editor")
- Title: "Expert Video Editor | YouTube, Reels, Ads"
- Employment (1):
    - Upwork — Video Editor
- Pattern: "Upwork" as the employer, plain title. Overview has a "Key Skills" pipe keyword block and two pasted client reviews.

11. Barzaan Ali K. — Pakistan

- Stats: Top Rated · $30K+ · 228 jobs · JSS 100 · $9/hr

- Searches: 3 of 7 · avg rank 4.7
- Title: "YouTube Video Editor | Faceless & Talking Head Video Editing"
- Employment (4):
  - Pixelon Production — 💼 Founder
  - Freelance — 💼 Lead YouTube Editor & Content Strategist
  - Xpert Creation — 💼 Team Lead Video Editors
  - Black Bird Productions — 💼 Junior Video Editor
- Pattern: A career ladder (Junior → Team Lead → Founder) with emoji. Overview repeats "YouTube Video Editor" about 6 times naturally.

12. Vo N. (Nhat) — Vietnam

- Stats: Top Rated Plus · $60K+ · 140 jobs · JSS 99 · $30/hr
- Searches: 3 of 7 · avg rank 15.7
- Title: "Video Editor | YouTube, Tiktok, IG, LinkedIn | Long & Short Form"
- Employment (2):
  - FPT Media — Video Editor
  - Viettel — Telecommunications Engineer
- Pattern: Honest real employers that match his degrees. Short overview; keywords live in 18 portfolio titles.

3C. No badge (12)

"RT" = appeared in Rising Talent searches (badge guessed from the search filter, not shown on the profile).

1. Mustafa I. — Pakistan

- Stats: No badge (RT) · $2K+ · 47 jobs · JSS 100 · $5/hr
- Searches: 3 of 7 open + 4 of 4 RT · avg rank **4.1**
- Title: "YouTube Video Editor | Reels, Shorts, Ads & Motion Graphics"
- Employment (2):
  - IBEX Global — Video Editor
  - Arena Multimedia — Video editor and Motion graphic artist
- Pattern: Plain titles. Keywords woven into long service bullets, no dump. Strongest no-badge ranker.

2. Tatheer A. — Pakistan

- Stats: No badge · $2K+ · 55 jobs · JSS 88 · $5/hr
- Searches: 5 of 7 open · avg rank 9.2
- Title: "Short Form Video Editor | YouTube Shorts, Reels & TikTok Editor"
- Employment (1):
  - Team AR — Video Editor

- Pattern: One plain entry. Overview copies buyer phrases exactly ("YouTube Shorts editor, Reel editor, TikTok video editor") and ends with a keyword list, one per line. About 10 small orders in 3 weeks.

3. Dua D. — Pakistan

- Stats: No badge (RT) · $2K+ · 21 jobs · JSS 100 · $20/hr
- Searches: 1 of 7 open + 4 of 4 RT · avg rank 4.6
- Title: "Short-Form Video Editor for TikTok, Instagram Reels & YouTube Shorts"
- Employment (3):
  - Remotely — Short Form Video Editor
  - Remotly — Podcast Clips Editing
  - Remotely — YouTube Video Editore
- Pattern: Placeholder company; each job title is one search keyword (one per service). Overview ends with three keyword blocks (Title Case, lowercase, hashtags).
- ⚠ Typos "Remotly" and "Editore".

4. Sana A. — United Arab Emirates

- Stats: No badge · $1K+ · 16 jobs · JSS 88 · $12/hr
- Searches: 2 of 7 open · avg rank **3.0**
- Title: "Video Editing Expert | Short-Form Videos | AI Video, Reels & TikTok"
- Employment (5):
  - Xpo9tial — Video Editor & AI Video Specialist
  - One Hub — Senior Video Editing & Short-Form Content Expert
  - DigixStudio — Short-Form Video Editor & Social Media Content Creator
  - Prism Digital — Video Editor & Motion Graphics Specialist
  - Bruce Clay MENA — Expert Video Editor & Video Advertising Specialist
- Pattern: Agency names plus compound "X & Y Specialist" keyword titles. Overview ends with a pipe "Video Editing Services" block.
- ⚠ All 5 added in one batch; Bruce Clay is a known brand; overview claims "100% JSS" but real JSS is 88.

5. Ammad R. — Pakistan

- Stats: No badge · $100K+ · 249 jobs · JSS 100 · $19/hr
- Searches: 2 of 7 open · avg rank 18.0
- Title: "AI Video Ads & UGC Editor | Scroll-Stopping Ads for DTC Brands"
- Employment (2):
  - Theblackbirdproduction — Video Editor
  - Metro News — News Editor
- Pattern: Plain and real-sounding. Overview is sales copy with named brands and a free "hook edit" offer; no keyword block. Ads-only focus = fewer searches.
- ⚠ Portfolio title left with template text "[SaaS / Consultant]".

6. Areej R. — Pakistan

- Stats: No badge (RT) · $1K+ · 15 jobs · JSS 100 · $10/hr
- Searches: 4 of 4 RT · avg rank 4.0
- Title: "Video Editor for Reels, TikTok & YouTube Shorts | Viral Content Expert"
- Employment (4):
  - Anas Tours & Travels Pvt — UGC Video Editor I Trend Researcher
  - HBCU Creatives — Social Media Video Editor
  - Reuben Eczema Pvt — Video Editor and Trend Finder
  - Kia Motors — Reels, Tiktok & Shorts Editor
- Pattern: Client and industry names; job titles hold platform keywords.
- ⚠ "Kia Motors" big brand; all 4 added in one batch; a portfolio description copied from another freelancer.

7. Linh D. — Vietnam

- Stats: No badge (RT) · $500+ · 12 jobs · JSS 100 · $10/hr
- Searches: 4 of 4 RT · avg rank 5.5
- Title: "Senior Video Editor | High-Retention Short-Form & YouTube Content"
- Employment (1):
  - vận chuyển — editor
- Pattern: Placeholder entry (Vietnamese for "shipping"). Overview offers a free 30-second trial and ends with ~45 hashtags.
- ⚠ Portfolio image says "TOP RATED UPWORK FREELANCER" but she has no badge.

8. Lam P. — Vietnam

- Stats: No badge (RT) · $900+ · 10 jobs · JSS 100 · $6/hr
- Searches: 3 of 4 RT · avg rank **1.7**
- Title: "Professional Video Editor | Instagram | Youtube | Tiktok | Reels"
- Employment (2):
  - Xuan Phuoc Lam — Youtuber
  - Rom Media — Editor video
- Pattern: Own name plus one media company; plain titles. Short, plain overview with no keyword block, yet tops Rising Talent searches.

9. Dung N. (Quang Dũng) — Vietnam

- Stats: No badge (RT) · $1K+ · 13 jobs · JSS 100 · $15/hr
- Searches: 4 of 4 RT · avg rank 8.2
- Title: "Professional Video Editor | Youtube Video | Shorts Video Expert"
- Employment (3):
  - Self-Employed / Freelance — Video Editor
  - Self-Employed / Freelance — Video Editor | YouTube & Short-Form Content
  - vnexpess — Video editor

- Pattern: Freelance entries; one job title copies the profile-title formula. "Video Editor" repeated in overview headings.
- ⚠ "vnexpess" typo; a doctorate in the same years as his bachelor's; portfolio text copied from Luong Tan D.

10. Syed R. — Pakistan

- Stats: No badge (RT) · $1K+ · 27 jobs · JSS 100 · $6/hr
- Searches: 4 of 4 RT · avg rank 8.2
- Title: "Video Editor | YouTube Videos, Meta Ads, TikTok Ads, Insta Reels"
- Employment (2):
  - Diligenttek — Social Media Manager & Video Ad Designer
  - Bits N Digits — Video Editor
- Pattern: Small agencies, plain titles. Overview uses 22 keyword-style service lines instead of a dump.

11. Samar F. — Pakistan

- Stats: No badge (RT) · $6K+ · 10 jobs · JSS 100 · $10/hr
- Searches: 4 of 4 RT · avg rank 17.0
- Title: "High-Retention Video Editor | Reels, TikTok, Shorts & UGC Ads"
- Employment (2):
  - TUMARA TEXTILE — Video Editor
  - Jade textile LIMITED — VIDEO EDITOR
- Pattern: In-house jobs at textile firms, plain titles. Short, tight overview with a free-sample offer.

12. Bao N. — Vietnam

- Stats: No badge (RT) · $2K+ · 18 jobs · JSS 100 · $20/hr
- Searches: 4 of 4 RT · avg rank 14.8
- Title: "AI Video Editor & AI Video Creator | YouTube, UGC, Tiktok & Meta Ads"
- Employment (1):
  - MCV GROUP CORPORATION — Video Editor
- Pattern: One real-sounding media group, plain title. Overview uses ALL-CAPS emoji section headers, no keyword dump.

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4. Patterns summary

4.1 How they name the company

Style	Who uses it	Good ranking?
Real small company or client	Anu F., Edmond O., Hafsa H., Abdullah D., Mustafa I.	Yes, common in top earners

Style	Who uses it	Good ranking?
Freelance / Self-Employed / Upwork	Isaac T., Minh K., Tatheer A., Dung N., Toba A.	Yes (Isaac #1–2)
Own studio as Founder	Fawas P., Barzaan Ali K.	Yes, high earners
Keywords in company field	Luong Tan D., Ejiofor J.	Mixed
Invented brands or client descriptions	Kazeem M., Nawwal I., Ejiofor J.	No (avg rank ~17–20)
Big-brand name-drop ⚠	Emmanuel E., Giang P., Areej R., Sana A.	Not the reason they rank
Non-video past jobs kept	Jules, Chinenyenwa E., Vo N.	Does not hurt

4.2 How they write the job title

Style	Example	Who
Plain role	"Video Editor"	About half of all entries
Mirrors profile title	"YouTube Video Editor | Shorts & Sports Editor"	Isaac T., Alonge T., Dung N.
One keyword per entry	"Podcast Clips Editing"	Dua D., Kaiwan I.
" at "	"...Editor at Xteam Studios"	Anu F.
Career ladder	Junior → Team Lead → Founder	Barzaan Ali K., Syed Muhammad A.
ALL-CAPS template ⚠	"INSTAGRAM REELS & AI VIDEO EDITOR | ..."	Nawwal I.

4.3 Profile title formula

`[Role] | [TikTok, Reels, YouTube Shorts] & [one niche]`

- 15 of 16 Nigerians use the pipe "|".
- The people found in the most searches name YouTube, Shorts, Reels, TikTok (and often ads/UGC) in the title.
- Common niches: sports, talking-head, podcast clips, wellness, ads/UGC.
- Examples: "Short-Form Video Editor | Talking Head Reels, TikTok & Podcast Clips" (Favour I.); "Short Form Video Editor | YouTube Shorts, Reels & TikTok Editor" (Tatheer A.).

4.4 Overview structure (most common order)

1. **Hook** — a question ("Need...?", "Tired of...?") or a bold claim.
2. **Who I help + what I turn into what** — with the platform words (20 of 24 global profiles name Reels/TikTok/Shorts in the first 400 characters).
3. **Proof** — numbers (views, videos, earnings) or a named client or review.
4. **Services list** — 4–15 bullets, each reads like a search phrase.
5. **How I work / why me / tools** — CapCut, Premiere Pro, After Effects, DaVinci.
6. **Call to action** — often a free sample, trial edit or audit.
7. **Keyword block** (optional) at the end.

4.5 Keyword blocks seen

- **Pipe line:** Paula E., Nawwal I., Sana A., Minh K.
- **Comma list:** Edmond O., Chris C., Geraldine O., Syed Muhammad A. ("Keywords for UMA and Client Matching:"), Fawas P.
- **One per line / hashtags:** Tatheer A., Dua D., Linh D.
- **Woven into bullets, no block:** Mustafa I., Barzaan Ali K., Syed R.
- **Too much ⚠:** Ejiofor J. (same block 3 times), Kaiwan I. (25+ repeats hidden under blank lines).

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5. What to copy and what to avoid

Copy:

- Keep platform words in your title (you already do). Add one niche at the end.
- Put the exact buyer phrases (Short-Form Video Editor, TikTok, Reels, YouTube Shorts) in your first two overview lines.
- Write service bullets that read like searches: "YouTube Shorts editing", "Podcast clips", "Talking-head Reels".
- End with a short keyword line (Paula E. or Tatheer A. style).
- Offer a free sample or trial edit in your call to action.
- Keep employment to 1–4 honest entries. "Freelance" or "Self-Employed" is fine.
- Name portfolio items like searches: "[Format] Edit | [Niche]".

Avoid:

- ⚠ Big brands you never worked for (Tencent, S&P Global, Kia Motors, THG).
- ⚠ Invented companies or 100 copy-paste entries — they ranked worst.
- ⚠ Fake schools or impossible degrees.
- ⚠ Claims your stats don't show ("100% JSS", "Top Rated").
- ⚠ Copying job-post text or other freelancers' portfolio text.
- ⚠ Huge repeated or hidden keyword dumps.
- Typos in company names or titles ("reelance", "editer", "Remotly").

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6. Harry's employment plan

Plan: add **1–4 honest entries**. Use real clients or work only. If you have no clients yet, one "Freelance" entry is enough (Isaac T. ranks #1–2 with just that).

> **These are templates, not real entries.** Replace every [bracket] with your real work. Do not add a client, brand, number or date you cannot back up.

Template 1 — your freelance work (use this first)

Field	What to enter
Company	Freelance (Self-Employed)
Job title	Short-Form Video Editor | Reels, TikTok & Shorts
Role (≤50 chars)	Short-Form Video Editor
City / Country	Lagos / Nigeria (NG)
Dates	From [fill in] – Present

Description (under 1,000 characters):

> I edit short-form videos for creators, coaches and small brands. I turn raw footage, talking-head clips and podcast episodes into TikTok videos, Instagram Reels and YouTube Shorts. What I do: • Hook in the first 3 seconds, tight pacing, jump cuts • Animated captions that work with the sound off • B-roll, zooms, sound effects and music • Podcast and long-video repurposing into clips • 9:16 export for each platform Tools: CapCut, [Premiere Pro / DaVinci Resolve — only what you use]. Work so far: [number] videos for [number] clients in [niche]. [One real result, e.g. a view count — only if true.]

Template 2 — a real client you edited for

Field	What to enter
Company	[Real client or brand name]
Job title	Reels & TikTok Video Editor
Role (≤50 chars)	Short-Form Video Editor – [niche]
City / Country	Lagos / Nigeria (NG) — or the client's city
Dates	[fill in] – [fill in]

Description (under 1,000 characters):

> Edited short-form videos for [client name], a [type of business, e.g. fashion brand]. I took their raw clips and turned them into Instagram Reels, TikTok videos and YouTube Shorts. • Edited [number] videos per [week/month] • Wrote on-screen hooks and captions • Added music, sound effects and branded text • Delivered in [time, e.g. 24–48 hours] Result: [real result if you have one, e.g. "a Reel reached X views"]. Tools: [tools you used].

Template 3 — your Upwork work (add after your first Upwork jobs)

Field	What to enter
Company	Upwork

Field	What to enter
Job title	Short-Form Video Editor – Podcast Clips & Reels
Role (≤50 chars)	Freelance Short-Form Video Editor
City / Country	Lagos / Nigeria (NG)
Dates	From [fill in] – Present

Description (under 1,000 characters):

> Freelance short-form video editor on Upwork. I edit TikTok videos, Instagram Reels, YouTube Shorts and podcast clips for clients in [countries/niches]. • [number] contracts completed, [number] videos delivered • Talking-head, podcast and UGC-style edits • Captions, hooks, b-roll, sound design • Fast turnaround and clear updates [Short real client quote, if you have one.]

"Other experience" template (add this by hand on your profile; the data tools cannot see this section)

- **Title:** Short-Form Video Editing Practice Projects
- **Description:**

> I practise short-form editing every week to sharpen my skills. I re-edit [type of footage, e.g. free podcast clips or my own videos] into TikTok, Reels and YouTube Shorts versions. Each edit focuses on a strong 3-second hook, fast pacing, animated captions and clean sound. Samples are in my portfolio: [list real portfolio item names].

Profile keys (for checking): Emmanuel E. ~016ecb7f776e6e9021 · Isaac T. ~0188591cbb01c79e7a · Edmond O. ~01d4fec8b522fa4462 · Anu F. ~01442ee478a70618cf · Geraldine O. ~01952240dd71c58a6b · Favour I. ~019e8e36b7e6740cc3 · Alonge T. ~010199137e63b3f680 · Ayomide O. ~019ddcf392d482f556 · Ejiofor J. ~0139b5152f85e4be35 · Chris C. ~01a8ddc5785d734d2f · Jules ~0166f124d0b7da15a2 · Paula E. ~01ddfa32109e3c2789 · Oluwatoba A. ~01e3968da192142afa · Chinenyenwa E. ~0125c8b28b9f0edd19 · Kazeem M. ~01a64ee7f64757a556 · Nawwal I. ~01570c8b3355d205e1 · Hafsa H. ~01839f946ded0eeacf · Giang P. ~0143a42d619d02f86b · Luong Tan D. ~017317c428378d833e · Abdullah D. ~0169d35b8373416546 · Syed Muhammad A. ~0172a72d3c9bbeca91 · Umair T. ~0136e707e4c588907b · Fawas P. ~011179e46730c1b40e · Van Trung N. ~013f7e0b7640d12ec1 · Kaiwan I. ~01852d9cb546721b87 · Minh K. ~0173c53bf41cdcb449 · Barzaan Ali K. ~01177bdac836ce4770 · Vo N. ~0164bae49ec98f51a9 · Mustafa I. ~017ed4c94770e7cffe · Tatheer A. ~01b6f6b334ae3c0ca6 · Dua D. ~0130d0b5925f90fb17 · Sana A. ~01ec0d6dfedfdb3147 · Ammad R. ~01af61047f5376d415 · Areej R. ~010b18432e7351053b · Linh D. ~01b6927b7b77f22bf9 · Lam P. ~012bbff8874481ee30 · Dung N. ~01f577ffc76cb46749 · Syed R. ~01a49b8e3013583ba1 · Samar F. ~0155567c787d26a7d6 · Bao N. ~01521ccd8513ef4f1f